

The Love of God is Tangible

How many of you have no trouble agreeing that we are close to something? We are so close.

I used to think revival was measured by dessert: strawberry shortcake, strawberry cake, strawberry bread. You would think that whatever caused revival, as you grew closer to it, would feel like walking in a park where somebody had already cleared the brush and made a nice path for you.

If that were the case, revival would be in front of you and you would simply walk into it.

Make no mistake, though: we are close.

I do not know when I had this vision. I am not sure whether I dreamed it or it presented itself to me. All I know is that suddenly I had it, and I knew it was from God. It wrecked me.

It was a little boy, maybe four or five years old, twisted up. Whatever part of his body would work, he used to reach out. He could talk, but his body was twisted, and his diagnosis was, "Learn to live with it."

He reached those little hands out and said, "Please do not leave me this way. Promise me. Please do not stop and leave me this way."

It was very bold in the dream or vision. "Please do not stop. Do not leave me like this."

I told him, "I will not."

When I say we are close to something, if you asked me whether there is a target painted on my back, I would say no. I found out it is not painted. It is a neon sign.

In Mark 4, why does Satan come? Jesus said the sower sows the Word, and Satan comes immediately.

What is he after? Why is it so important for him to be the first thing to come after the Word? Jesus even gives the list of things he uses.

The most dangerous thing you wield is the truth. Satan comes for one reason: to remove, change, destroy, and erase all traces of truth.

His best success is not simply to take all of it away. That would be too obvious. He gives you an alternative to believe, usually religion with no power.

Look at history. Why is it so important for him to take truth away from us? Because truth is the most powerful thing you have.

I remember a time when I would beg God. Not for money, but when somebody was in pain, especially somebody I loved and they could not take it. I would say, "Please, God, please." Then I would start making deals. "I will sell out. What do You want?"

If I had realized what an insult begging is to God, I would never have done it.

I thought I was supposed to beg Him and talk Him into doing something. But He is the One who came. He is the One who paved a sovereign, unchanging road to the cross. He bore our sicknesses and carried our pains. The Father put His Son through that.

Who did He do it for?

Me.

After all that, do you think for one minute He is not trying to get it to me? Do you know what an insult it is to beg Him for something He gave His Son to make available?

Begging assumes He has decided not to do it and you must talk Him into it. That is not the case.

I had quite a time in Brazil. I was standing there as I usually do, waiting on God and taking direction, and He said, "There is somebody out there who has had a sore throat for two years, caused by a growth. That is why it never went away."

That night the man went home, started coughing and hacking at four in the morning, and choked up a growth about this big. He brought it back in a jar. His throat did not hurt anymore. For two years it had hurt.

They filmed him testifying and holding that thing up in a bottle. Do you not love it when God does things like that?

The miracles got strong. A woman had her arm fractured in five places and could not move it. I tried to pull her arm up, but it would only go so far. So I reached under it and said, "In the name of Jesus." Her arm went right up. That was Him.

The cast was in the way, so she went to the doctor, he took it off, and the next day she came back with her hand and arm working. She was excited.

About three hundred were filled with the Holy Ghost. Out of eleven hundred who came, someone estimated that about four hundred were healed.

But something else happened too.

I remember seeing a screen where someone was saying that if you gave his ministry a thousand dollars, God would give you a hundred thousand. One person walked by and said, "That is a bigger scam than the world has."

The second screen showed the miracles: people testifying with their crutches and things. But the third screen had to do with that key that unlocked my last door. The key before that was private worship. It finally wedged open the door of love.

I thought maybe it was revival. Light leaked out from behind that door, but it was private worship helping unlock the door to the love of God. That is what I believe began to pour out.

From the time His love came on me, I have not been able to get off it. I can start on almost anything and end up here.

I found out this love He has is tangible. It can be felt as a presence as surely as power can knock you off your feet. There is an anointing with His love that is very tangible and can be felt very powerfully.

In Brazil, even with the language barrier, people who looked hateful, discouraged, untrusting, used by the world, full of hatred, and beyond caring would come near that anointing and begin to weep. They had walked past money-grubbing religion and even past miracles, but there was something about this other anointing. Its presence was so heavy that they collapsed sobbing and said, "I have never felt anything like this before."

I thought private worship just affected worship services. If you did a lot of private worship, you would lead worship, and God would come. But there is more.

Think about the law of meditation and the law of confession. If you read a paragraph and I asked you to quote it back word for word, comma for comma, you probably could not. I could not either. Yet if you read it thirty times and paid attention, you could.

If you can do it after thirty times, then you had the capacity to do it. Something happened through repetition and attention.

The same principle works in prayer. The devil says, "You are not healed. You are going to die." You take the truth he tried to steal from you early in your walk:

Surely He hath borne our griefs
and carried our sorrows.
He was wounded for our transgressions,
bruised for our iniquities:
the chastisement of our peace was upon Him;
and with His stripes we are healed.

He bore my sicknesses and carried my pains. They were loaded on Him, and He died under the penalty of them. There is no disease He did not die under. That means when I died with Him, I already died to those things too. They are not going to kill me twice.

What happens when you walk the floor and say, "Surely He bore my sickness and carried my pains; therefore I am healed" a hundred times? What if you call yourself healed three or four hundred times? Something begins to happen inside you.

You are not moving God. He has already done it. You are moving yourself into a place to receive from Him because you will not stop.

We know God does tangible things. Many of you have felt His presence so strongly that you ended up on the floor. When God healed teeth, people started checking each other's mouths. If a stranger had walked in, he would have thought we had flipped.

We know God can come tangibly. He can come with peace until trouble leaves. He can come with such strength that you cannot stand on your feet.

Then tell me this: when He talks about the one thing that never fails, why would you think you could not feel that too?

One of the first things He taught me when I broke into private worship was to move from singing songs about Him to worshipping Him directly.

I could sing, "Our God is an awesome God," and after singing that two or three times, realize, yes, He is. But I went from singing about Him to talking to Him.

Some of my favorite sayings in worship became:

I want to thank You for loving me.

I want to thank You for loving me so much that You sent Jesus.

Jesus, You love me.

You died for me.

I worship You, glorify You, magnify You, and extol You.

You cannot do that for a day or two without it becoming tangible. You cannot keep doing that without ending up believing it.

Let me tell you who we are up against and how stubborn he is.

First there was Adam, then Eve. Two people on the planet in the garden. The devil came in, went to work on one, used that one to work on the other, and soon the whole population of the world fell.

Then they had Cain and Abel. The worst war ever fought in the history of the world wiped out one-fourth of the planet: Cain killed Abel. There were only four people, and one killed another.

Just because there are millions or billions now does not make him any less dangerous. Our opposition is stubborn, and what he wants to remove from you is truth.

But if you keep worshipping Him, eventually, just as with any other anointing that comes, there will be a tangible anointing of His presence and love. As far as I can see, He is beginning to succeed in places where I failed.

Do you think He loves you less now than when there were only two or four people? Numbers do not overwhelm Him. Eight hundred trillion is nothing to Him, because He came from forever and goes to forever. If you think He does not have time for you, I have good news: that is all He has.

When you step into His presence and say, "I am stopping my schedule to fellowship with You," do not think there is anything He will not do for you.

He confirmed to me that the devil is horrified along this road that you are really going to find out Christianity is a family, not a religion; that He really is your Father.

When you learn to approach Him as Father, the simple parables carry tons of weight. The disciples said, "Teach us to pray." Jesus said, "Say, Our Father which art in heaven." What a way to start.

Do you really mean it? Or do you mix Him up too much with God only?

If you were blessed with a good natural father, what could you not go to him about? Did you not feel safe?

Our Father. Really.

Jesus did not use Einstein's theory of relativity to explain answered prayer. He said, "Consider the fowls of the air." He said, "Consider the lilies of the field." Solomon in all his glory was not arrayed like one of these.

His next question was a mystery to Him: how is it that you have no faith?

How basic do we want Him to go?

What are you worth?

Angels do not procreate. He created every angel for the service He created them for. This is what makes us part of God's family in a unique way. We have the power to procreate an eternal little creature. Eighteen billion years from now, that person will be somewhere. The question is where.

I have decided to have revival. I have decided I can have what He said I could have.

Open to Luke 17. I have asked for an increase of faith, and I found out what brings it.

Jesus was teaching about offenses:

"It is impossible but that offences will come:
but woe unto him, through whom they come!"

He says it would be better for a millstone to be hanged around a man's neck and he be cast into the sea than that he should offend one of these little ones.

Then He says:

"Take heed to yourselves:
If thy brother trespass against thee,
rebuke him;
and if he repent,
forgive him.
And if he trespass against thee seven times in a day,
and seven times in a day turn again to thee, saying,
I repent;
thou shalt forgive him."

Peter, as Matthew records it, thought seven was a high number. Jesus said, "I say not unto thee, Until seven times: but, Until seventy times seven."

That sent Peter into shock. He said, "Lord, increase our faith."

Of all the times to ask for an increase of faith, this was when he asked. He did not ask it when the ship was sinking or when the multitude had nothing to eat. He asked it when Jesus talked about forgiving.

Jesus answered:

"If ye had faith as a grain of mustard seed,
ye might say unto this sycamine tree,
Be thou plucked up by the root,
and be thou planted in the sea;
and it should obey you."

Then Jesus asked questions so they could examine themselves. The larger teachings around this deal with offenses, unforgiveness, strife, and causing people to fall.

Are you telling me that straightening up those areas has something to do with an increase in the kind of faith that moves a tree or a mountain?

Yes, it does.

You are not going to habitually pray in tongues without being delivered to the love of God.

When I stepped into the Spirit, I was speaking His heart. The reason many fall short is because they are missing that one ingredient. Therefore they are caught up and diverted by many things.

But if you stay on this path and continue as I lay it out to you, you will not be diverted, nor will you pull up short. You will finish all I have given you to do.

Rejoice and be exceedingly glad. In My love and this key, many problems will be taken care of, even problems you did not know you had until they were erased. Be strong and continue in My Spirit so I can continue to put the right key in your hand at the right time, saith the Lord.

How does this increase faith?

Suppose there is something in you, a strife or dislike, and then you start worshiping God. His love begins to manifest in you. Pretty soon it reaches the part of you that is able to be ugly. The two will not stay in the same vessel. They will not mix.

You may think God is just blessing you, but He is eradicating something that kept your faith from moving in that area. Once it is removed by the love of God, He can move where one time He could not.

So do not stop.

How can I use confession adequately now? Because I understand it. At first I thought it was just repetition, and the devil pulled that on me at every turn. But I knew there was something to it.

I would hear nothing, say nothing, and deny everything else that was not the truth. I kept saying the truth until I believed it.

When I studied men of God who were powerfully used, I looked for the common thread in why many of them were stopped. All people can do is speculate, but I wanted to know about surviving and finishing.

All twelve apostles, except for what happened by persecution and calling, went out and did what Jesus did. From translation to raising the dead, they became disciples. It was not just one who succeeded. Most of those trained in the early church got off the ground too.

The devil took a long time to introduce religion and confuse things.

This part I think I know for sure: if the love of God had kept up with the power, some would not have been destroyed.

I plan on finding out.

If love is allowed to grow and become as much your nature and action as power is, it seems to take care of the troubled areas that could take you down.

I know this: the devil fought harder and seemed more fearful over me discovering more about the love of God than almost anything else. He would rather I go after the word "power" than know God like that.

I am speaking in future tense, not unbelief: we are going to have both. I do not just want to see fifty wheelchairs emptied. I want to see you emptied, trained, and sent to do the same works.

Jesus made disciples. He did not make men who made everyone dependent on them. Most pastorates keep people dependent, as though they cannot get to God unless they go through the pastor. We are supposed to be pastored, but we are also supposed to be disciplined.

These signs shall follow those who believe.